Dial Tool

Guidebook
beta 4.36 · October 2026

A tool for drawing watch dials in a web browser. You describe a dial the way a watchmaker would think about it — a few rings of marks and numbers, three hands, a window or two — and it draws it at its true size, ready to print, etch or cut.

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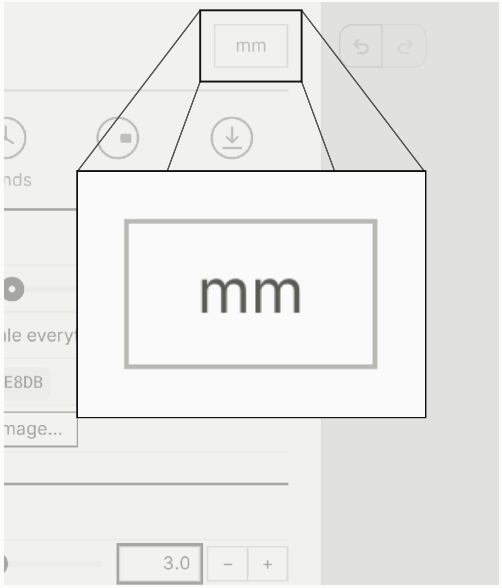
Left, in grey, the same dial as the print mask the tool exports for etching. Right, the dial.

Start

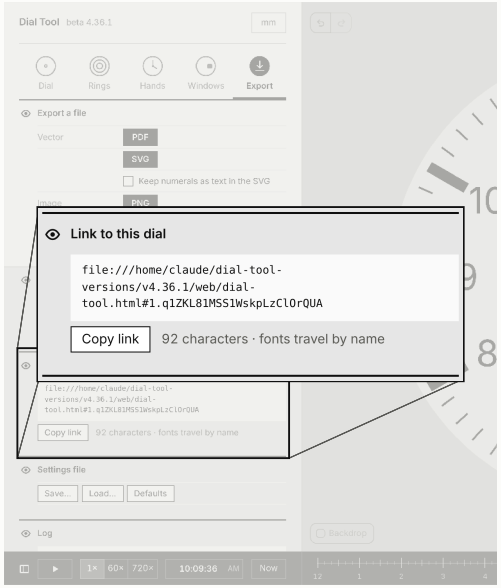
Open the address and start drawing. Nothing to install, nothing to sign up for.



Where it lives. The tool is a single web page: duztman.github.io/dial-tool. It works in any current browser on a Mac or a PC, and on an iPad with your finger. Chrome and Edge do a little more: they can use the fonts already on your computer.

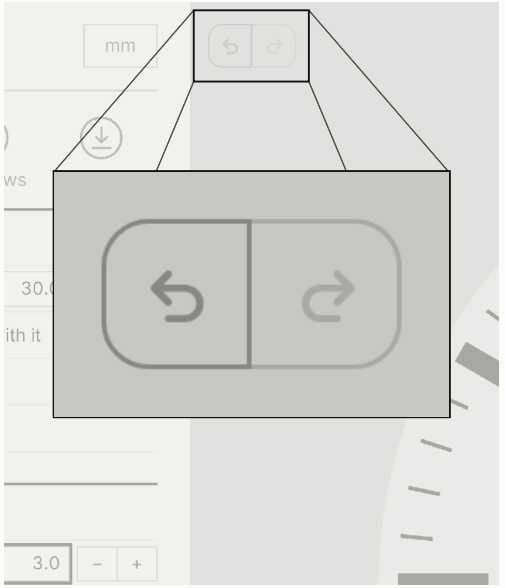


Everything is in millimetres. A dial here is the size it will be on your wrist, usually between 28 and 40 mm across. Every length you type is a real length. If you think in points, inches or **lignes** (the watchmaker's own unit), change it in the box at the top right; the dial doesn't change, only the numbers you read.



The link is the dial. Whatever you draw is written into the page's address as you go. Copy the address and you have saved the dial; send it to someone and they open the same dial. There is no account and no file to keep, unless you want one.

⚠ **Watch.** A link carries the dial, not the fonts. If you used a font from your own computer, the person you send it to needs the same font, or they will see a stand-in.

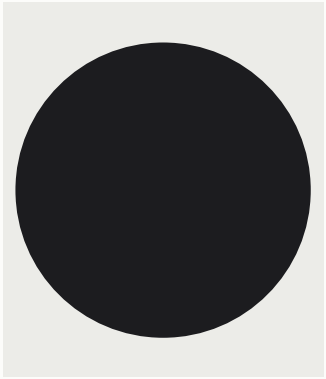


Changed your mind? Undo and redo sit at the top left of the dial (⌘Z and ⇧⌘Z on a keyboard). The tool remembers each change once you stop for a moment.

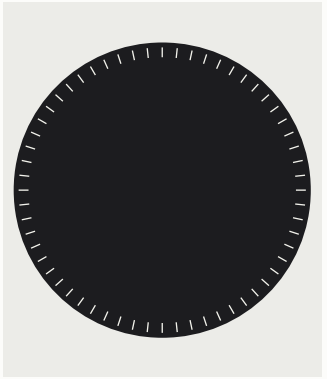
A

A first dial, in ten pictures

From an empty plate to a field watch in ten steps. Each picture is one change.



1 · The plate
Open the Dial tab. Set the diameter to 36 and pick a colour for the plate. This is the disc everything else sits on.



2 · The minute track
Open Rings and add a ring of ticks. Sixty short lines around the edge: this is the minute track every watch has.



3 · The hours
Add a ring of markers: twelve bars, longer and wider than the minute ticks, at the same distance from the centre.



4 · Let them make room
The minute ticks still run under the hour bars. Tell the ticks to **give way** to the markers and they step aside wherever a bar stands.



5 · The numbers
Add a ring of numerals. Twelve numbers, inside the markers. Move them in or out until they breathe.



6 · The font
Choose a font for the numerals from the list. You see every font as numbers, so you choose by eye, not by name.



7 · The hands
Open Hands. Pick a shape for the hour, minute and seconds hand, and make each one long enough to reach its own ring.



8 · A date
Open Windows and switch on the window at 3. A small opening appears with a date in it; type the one you want it to show.



9 · Colour
Give the seconds hand a colour of its own. One accent is usually enough.



dial.svg · 40 × 40 mm

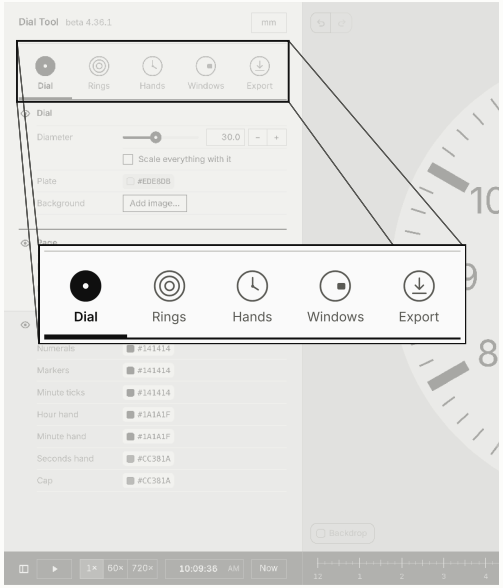
10 · Out
Open Export and save the dial as a PDF or SVG, drawn at its true size, or as a PNG picture. In an SVG the numerals can stay as editable text.



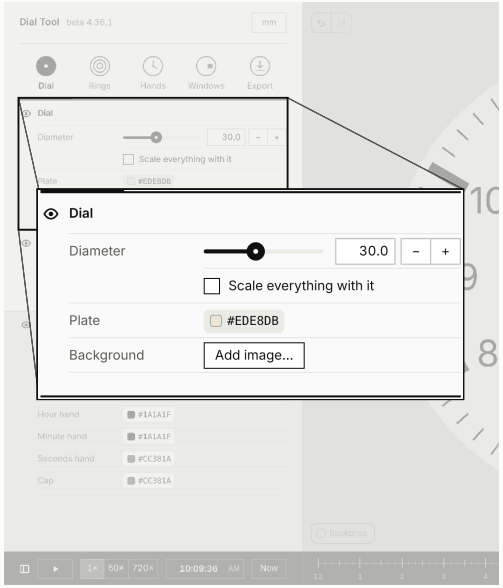
The finished dial. Open it in the tool and take it apart, ring by ring: every step above is still in it.

The window

Settings on the left, your dial on the right, the time along the bottom.



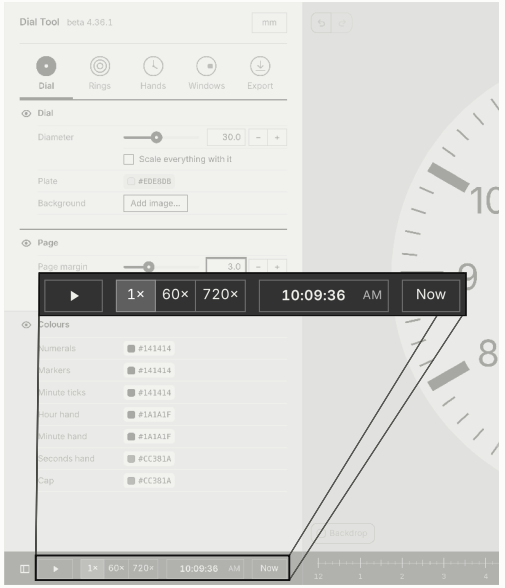
Five tabs. Across the top of the panel: Dial, Rings, Hands, Windows and Export. Each opens its own set of settings below. You will spend most of your time in Rings.



The panel. Settings come in groups, each under a thick line with a name. The eye beside a name folds the group away when you don't need it. Some lines stay pinned at the top while the rest scrolls, so you always know which ring or hand you are working on.



Point and click. Hover over any part of the dial and its name appears; click it and the panel jumps to its settings. This is often the quickest way to find something.

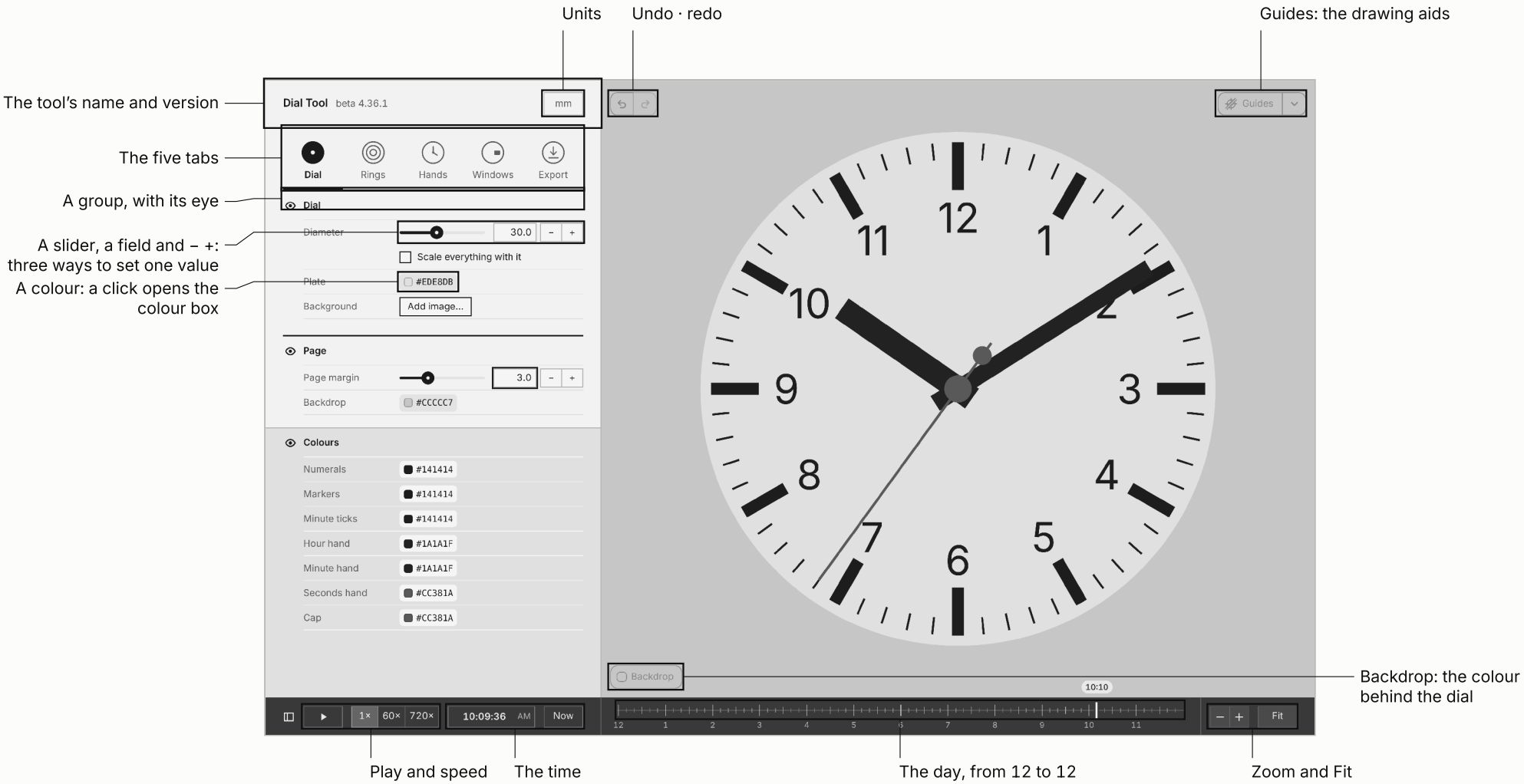


The bottom bar. The hands follow the time. Play them at real speed, sixty times or seven hundred and twenty times faster, or drag along the bar to any hour. A click lands exactly on the hour, or on 10:10, the time watches are photographed at.

The dial. It is drawn live: every change shows at once. Drag or scroll to move it; pinch, or hold ⌘ and scroll, to zoom. **Fit** brings the whole page back into view.

The whole window

The whole window in grey, every part boxed and named.

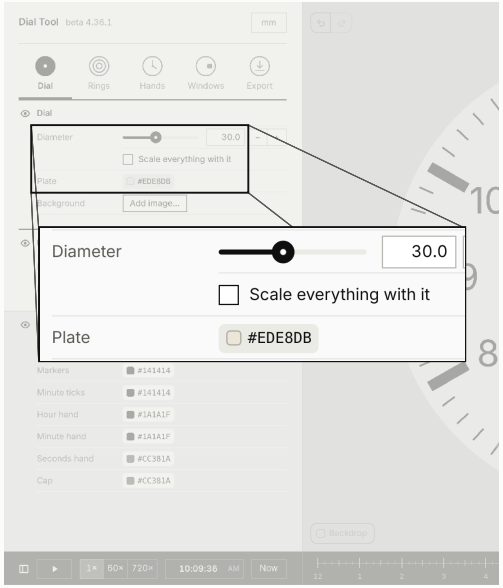


Typing numbers. A number field also does small sums: type **+0.5** to add, **x2** to double, **/3** to take a third. Useful when a drawing says "a third of the radius".

On an iPad. Everything works by finger. Small controls answer to a press a little outside their edge, and a number field grows larger when you touch it.

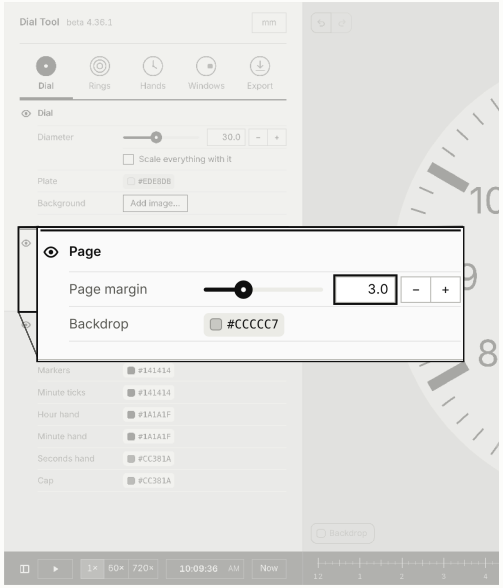
Dial and page

The plate, the space around it, and every colour on the dial in one list.

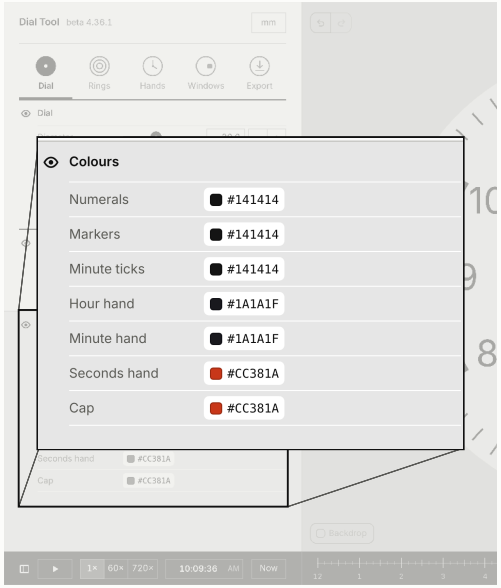


Diameter. How wide the dial is, edge to edge. Tick **Scale everything with it** and the whole design grows or shrinks with it, rings, numerals and hands together. Leave it off to resize the plate alone and keep every ring where it is.

Plate. The colour of the dial itself.



Page. When you export, the dial sits on a page with a margin around it. The backdrop is the colour you see behind the dial on screen; it is never exported.



Colours, all in one place. The last group lists every colour the dial uses: each ring, each hand, the cap, each window. Change them here when you want to see the whole palette at once.

⚠ **Watch.** Your palette is kept by your browser, not by the dial. A link carries the dial's colours, not your palette.



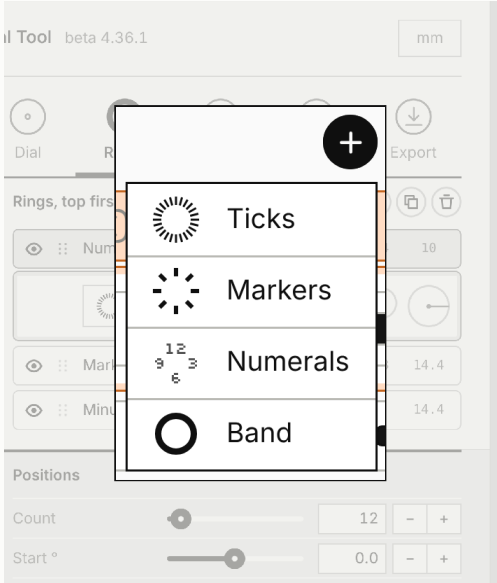
The colour box. Any colour opens the same box beside it. The top row shows the colours already on this dial, so it is easy to reuse one. The second row is your own palette of ten, plus any you add. Below are the colour field and its values, which you can copy. Rings can also be see-through: lower the opacity to let the plate show through.

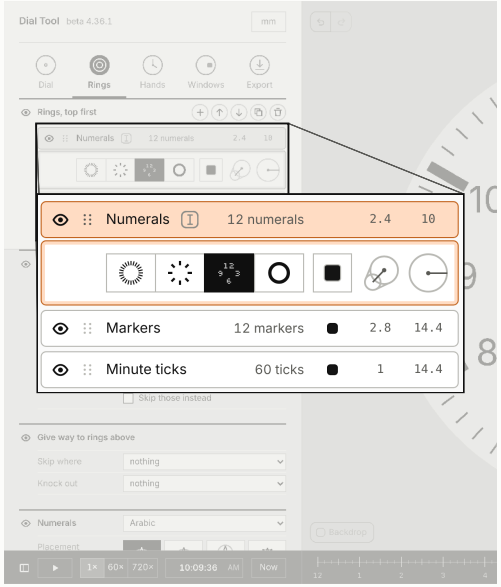
06

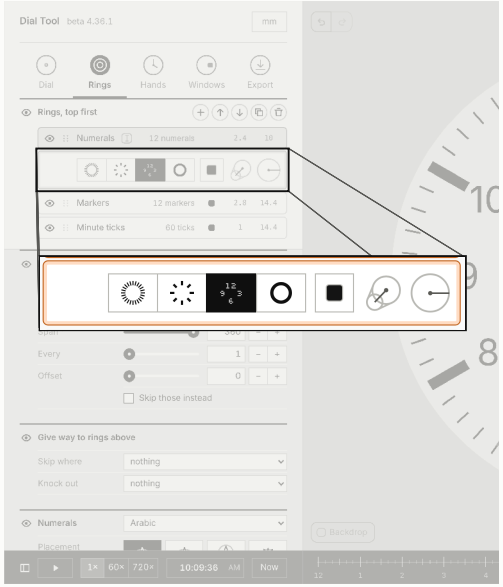
Rings

A dial is a short list of rings. Each ring repeats one thing around the centre.









One idea. Almost everything printed on a dial is something repeated in a circle: sixty ticks, twelve bars, twelve numbers, a coloured ring. So the tool has only one thing to build with: the ring. A field watch is four or five of them. A complicated dial might be fifteen.

Four kinds. A ring repeats **ticks** (thin lines, like a minute track), **markers** (heavier shapes for the hours), **numerals** (numbers or words) or a **band** (a ring of flat colour). You can change a ring's kind at any time; it keeps everything you set.

Top first. The list is in stacking order. The ring at the top is drawn last, in front of the others. Drag a ring by its handle to move it up or down.

Working on a ring. Click a ring to choose it. Under it opens a small drawer with its main controls: its kind, its colour, its size and its distance from the centre. Everything else about the ring follows in the groups below. The eye in its row hides a ring without deleting it; click its name to rename it.

Copy and reuse. The buttons on the list's heading add, move, duplicate and delete. A numerals ring can also take the type of another one, so two rings of numbers always match.

B